How to Notify USCIS of an Address Change

It is a legal requirement for all aliens in the U.S. to notify USCIS **within 10 days of change of address,** regardless of whether a benefit request is pending.

Noncompliance is a misdemeanor punishable by a fine of up to $5,000 or imprisonment for not more than thirty days, or both (*See 8 U.S.C. 1306(b); 18 U.S.C. 3559(a)(8), 3571(b)(6)*). In addition, any alien who has failed to comply with the change-of-address notification requirements of 8 U.S.C. 1305 is deportable unless the alien establishes that such failure was reasonably excusable or was not willful (*See 8 U.S.C. 1227(a)(3)(A)*).

To notify USCIS of your address change, you can 1) choose to **create an online account with USCIS (if you do not already have one) and update your address through this online account** or 2) choose to mail a paper AR-11 to USCIS. Please note that we strongly recommend using UCSIC online account to update your address so that proof of compliance can be saved.

Option 1 (STRONGLY RECOMMENDED):

To change your address with USCIS, please first create your own USCIS online account at https://myaccount.uscis.gov/users/sign_up.

After you sign in to your account, on the upper right-hand side menu of the MyUSCIS homepage (https://my.uscis.gov/), please choose "My Account" and click on "Change your address."

Please read the instructions (https://my.uscis.gov/accounts/change-of-address/start/overview) on the "Change your address" page carefully, and then click on the "Change my address" button. You will be asked to fill out your full name, date of birth, and A-number. Note that you can simply tick the "I do not have or know my A-Number" box if you do not know your A-number.

Under the "What is your new physical address?" section, please make sure to fill out the address where you currently live. If you do not want to use the physical address as your mailing address, then you can answer "No" to the question "Is your new physical address the same as your mailing address?". After you answer "No," the section "What is your new mailing address?" will show up for you to provide a mailing address that is different from your physical address.

Proprietary Confidential Documents

As a reminder, if you use your friend's or relative's address and your name is not listed on the mailbox of the mailing address, then you can indicate the full name of the mailbox owner in the "In care of name (if any)" column.

NOTE: If you do not have a pending case with USCIS, you can leave the section for "Case Information" blank. If you have pending cases with USCIS, enter the receipt numbers for each pending benefit request to apply the address change.

After the change of address request is submitted, you can keep track of your request by clicking on the "View my submissions" button.

Please save a screenshot after submitting the address update, as this may serve as proof of compliance if needed.

Proprietary Confidential Documents

Option 2 (NOT recommended as it does not provide proof of submission):

If you do not want to create a USCIS online account at this time, you can still use the AR-11 to update your address with USCIS. You can download the AR-11 here. Note that you will need to paper file the AR-11 to USCIS for address update.

When you complete AR-11, if you do not have an A number or do not know your A number, you can leave the item for A number blank.

For your previous address, you can just list your address before your current address on the form. If you have never moved since you came to the US, you can use your current address as both your current physical address and your previous address.

If you want to use an address that is different from your current physical address as your mailing address, please complete the section for "Mailing Address." Otherwise, you can leave the section for "Mailing Address" blank.

As mentioned, this approach is not recommended as you will not have any confirmation or proof for your report of address change. Considering that there are serious penalties for failure to report address change, it is strongly recommended that you choose to report your address change via option 1 as outlined on the first page of this document.